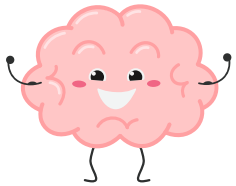
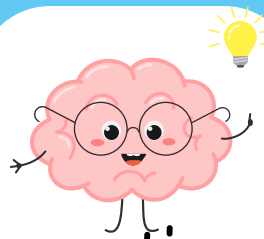
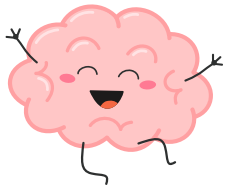
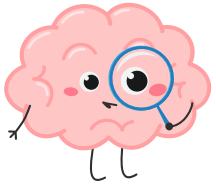
How is your BRAIN FEELING today?

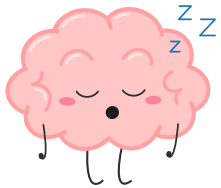

strong

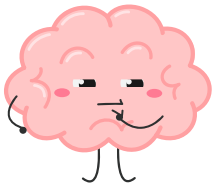

creative

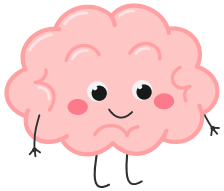

happy

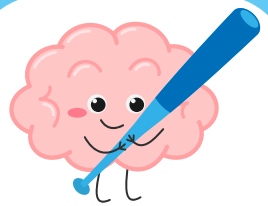

curious

funny


tired


reflective


calm


energetic

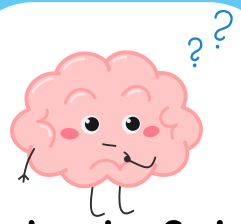
unsure

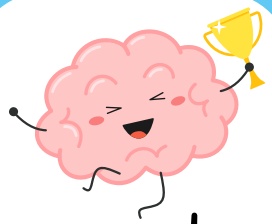
frustrated

motivated

angry

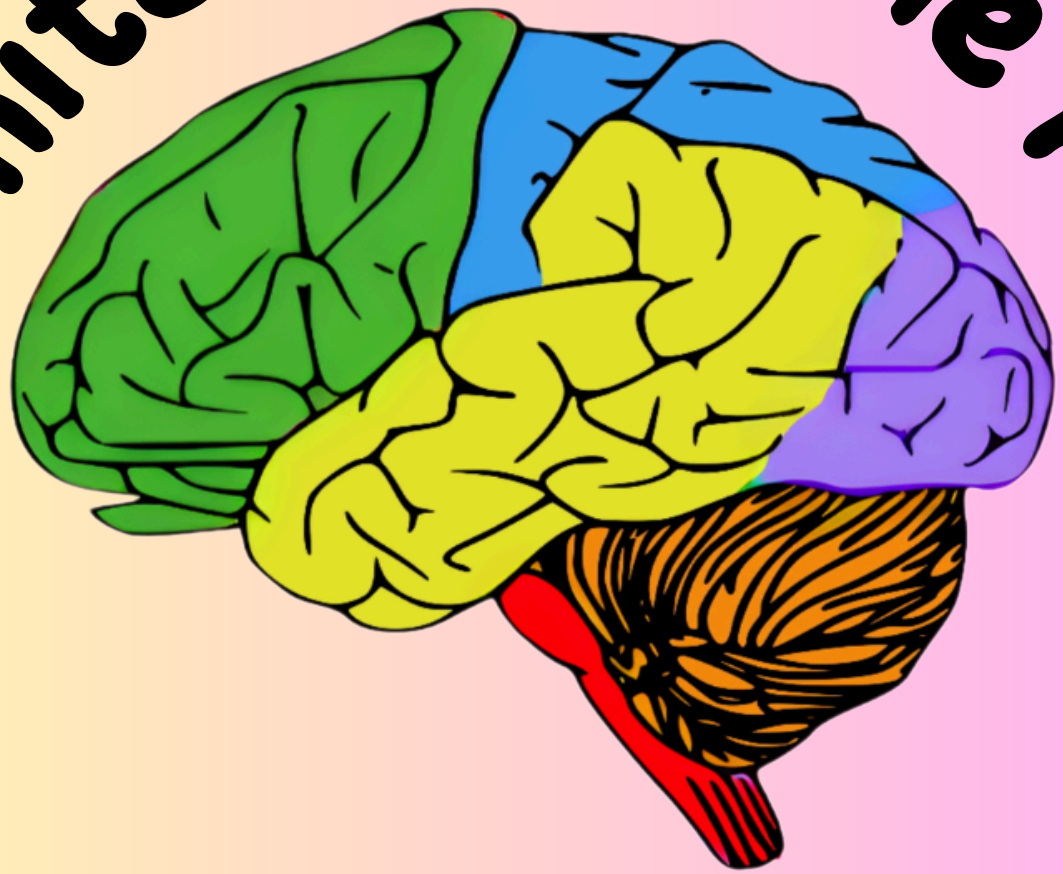
sad


doubtful


proud

relaxed

Architects of the Mind



The Brain Blueprint

Taking Charge of Your Dopamine

Essential Questions

THE MASTER BUILDER:

Am I using an app to build something new, or am I just scrolling through what others made?

THE DOPAMINE DETECTIVE:

Does my screen time give me "Quick Candy Joy" (cheap dopamine) that disappears fast, or "Hard-Work Happy" (earned joy) that makes me feel proud?

THE REMOTE CONTROL:

My Frontal Lobe is the "Boss" of my brain—is it making the choices right now, or is the app's "Infinite Scroll" in charge?

Essential Questions

THE MASTER BUILDER:

Am I using an app to build something new, or am I just scrolling through what others made?

THE DOPAMINE DETECTIVE:

Does my screen time give me "Quick Candy Joy" (cheap dopamine) that disappears fast, or "Hard-Work Happy" (earned joy) that makes me feel proud?

THE REMOTE CONTROL:

My Frontal Lobe is the "Boss" of my brain– is it making the choices right now, or is the app's "Infinite Scroll" in charge?

Why these questions matter!!

FRONTAL LOBE POWER:

THIS PART IS YOUR "THINKING HEADQUARTERS". IT HELPS YOU MAKE SMART DECISIONS ABOUT WHEN TO TAKE A "BRAIN BREAK".

THE JOY DIFFERENCE:

"CHEAP DOPAMINE" COMES FROM EASY THINGS LIKE SHORT VIDEOS.

"EARNED JOY" COMES FROM FINISHING SOMETHING HARD, LIKE CODING A GAME OR BUILDING A LEGO SET, AND IT HELPS YOUR BRAIN GROW STRONGER.

TECH CONNECTION:

SOME APPS ARE LIKE A "SUGAR RUSH" FOR YOUR BRAIN— THEY GIVE YOU FUN FAST, BUT IT DOESN'T LAST.

BUILDING AND CREATING APPS ACTIVATE YOUR FRONTAL LOBE FOR PLANNING AND PROBLEM-SOLVING.

3RD GRADE

THE BRAIN SCOUT

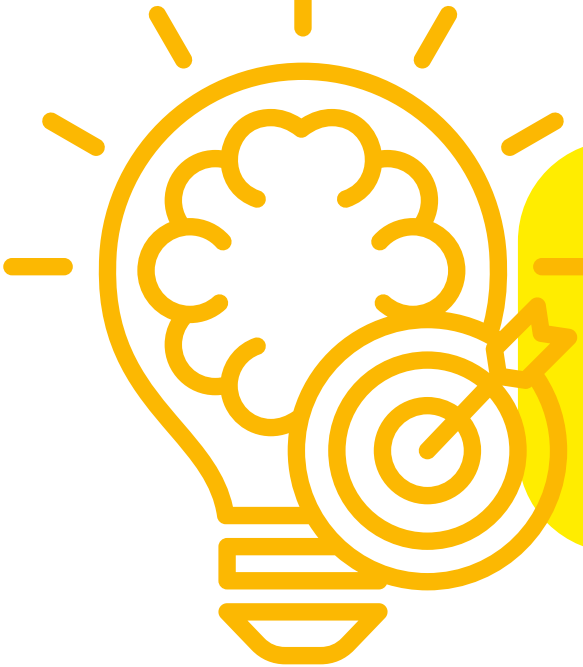
- I can name, and explain, my 4 main brain parts of my cerebrum.

- I can pause to see how my body feels during screen time.

4TH GRADE

THE DIGITAL DETECTIVE

- I can name, and explain, my 6 main parts of my brain.
- I can spot the difference between "Cheap Dopamine" (quick, bored feelings from scrolling) and "Earned Joy" (the proud feeling from finishing a hard build).
- I can spot "Digital Traps" (bright colors/dinging sounds) and know the difference between "Quick Candy" fun and "Hard-Work" happy.



5TH GRADE

THE BRAIN ARCHITECT

- I can name, and explain, my 6 main parts of my brain.
- I can explain how "Building Apps" (like coding or art) activate my Frontal Lobe for planning, while "Scrolling Apps" often bypass my thinking centers.
- I can use "If/Then Logic" to plan my screen time (e.g., "IF I finish 30 minutes of building, THEN I can have 10 minutes of scrolling").
- I can describe how my brain uses Neuroplasticity to grow stronger connections every time I choose a challenging "Hard-Work Happy" activity over an easy "Quick Candy" one.
- I can build a screen time plan that balances Input (watching) with Output (creating)!

The Master Builder's Glossary: Architects of the Mind

🧠 The Brain’s Structural Blueprint

Cerebrum: The biggest part of your brain. It is like a big office building with four different "rooms" called lobes.

Lobe: A specific section of the Cerebrum. Just like different rooms in a house have different jobs (like a kitchen for cooking), each lobe has a special job for your body.

Frontal Lobe: Your "Thinking Headquarters" or the "Boss" of your brain. It handles planning, making smart decisions, and moving your muscles.

Parietal Lobe: The "Navigator" of your brain . it helps you understand touch, temperature, and where your body is in space (like knowing where your hand is without looking).

Temporal Lobe: Your brain’s "Library" and "Sound Booth". It handles hearing, understanding language, and storing your favorite memories.

Occipital Lobe: Your brain's "Movie Screen". It processes everything you see, including colors, shapes, and movement.

Cerebellum: The "Balance Master" or "Pro Gamer" part of the brain. It coordinates your muscles so you can walk, ride a bike, or use a controller smoothly.

Brain Stem: Your "Life Support" system. It works on auto-pilot to control basic things like breathing, your heart rate, and sleep cycles.

🧪 The Science of the Build (Neurochemistry)

Dopamine: A chemical in your brain that acts like a "high-five". It is part of your reward system and makes you feel good when you do something fun or successful.

Quick "Cheap" Dopamine: A fast, bored feeling you get from just watching or scrolling. It feels good for a second—like a sugar rush—but it doesn't last long.

Earned "Hard-Work-Happy" Dopamine: The proud, lasting joy you feel after finishing something difficult. This is like "planting a garden" in your brain; it takes work, but the good feeling stays with you.

Neuroplasticity: The amazing fact that your brain is always growing and changing! When you practice hard things, you build stronger connections between your brain cells.

🧪 The Science of the Build (Neurochemistry)

Dopamine: A chemical in your brain that acts like a "high-five". It is part of your reward system and makes you feel good when you do something fun or successful.

Quick "Cheap" Dopamine: A fast, bored feeling you get from just watching or scrolling. It feels good for a second—like a sugar rush—but it doesn't last long.

Earned "Hard-Work-Happy" Dopamine: The proud, lasting joy you feel after finishing something difficult. This is like "planting a garden" in your brain; it takes work, but the good feeling stays with you.

Neuroplasticity: The amazing fact that your brain is always growing and changing! When you practice hard things, you build stronger connections between your brain cells.

💻 Digital Literacy & Tech Terms

If/Then Logic: A way of thinking (and coding!) where one action causes a specific result. Example: IF the player touches a coin, THEN they get a point.

Screen Time: The amount of time you spend using devices like phones, tablets, or computers.

Audit (Neural Audit): Checking in with your brain to see how an activity makes you feel. It helps you see which apps make you feel "stuck" and which ones make you feel "strong".

Architect: A person who plans and designs buildings. In this unit, YOU are the architect of your own mind!

Blueprint: A detailed plan. Your brain's blueprint shows how all the parts work together to help you navigate the world.

Create (Output): Using technology to build something new, like a game, a story, or a piece of art.

Consume (Input): Just watching or scrolling through what other people have made without making anything yourself.

Communicate: Using your brain (like the Temporal Lobe for language) and technology to share ideas and talk with others.